



» FIFA WORLD CUP
ANALYSIS

CROSS EXAMINATION

Wide threat: Pedro Porro's deliveries from the right embodied Spain's renewed faith in width, a defining tactical trend at the 2026 World Cup. AP

The 2026 World Cup marked the return of traditional wing play, with outswinging crosses playing a **pivotal role** from the knockout stage to the final.

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In the record books of Spain's 2026 World Cup-winning campaign, Nico Williams Jr.'s name will be remembered as the man who provided the assist for Ferran Torres' winner. Less spoken about, however, will be Pedro Porro's cross that made it possible.

In the final, for 105 minutes, Spain

battered the Argentina defence without reward. **Then, in the 106th minute, Lamine Yamal, as he had throughout the tournament, drew two markers towards him before finding fullback Porro in space.** Porro whipped in a first-time outswinging cross that had enough pace and swerve to confound Emiliano Martinez in the six-yard box and pull

four Argentina defenders towards their own goal. Williams Jr. did enough to head it back into an inviting area for an unmarked Torres to lash the ball into the roof of the net.

Porro's cross was Spain's 18th and final attempted cross of the game. Although it did not earn the assist, it was just as decisive, disrupting an Argentina defence that had held firm